Intubating LMA's are a special group of LMA's designed to aide in blind endotracheal intubation through the LMA itself. Intubating LMA's, such as the Fast-Trach-LMA, are different in structure from the classic LMA so that chances are increased for successful intubation of the trachea. The Intubating LMA is a multi-use device and should be cleaned and sterilized after each use.

The intubating LMA consists of a rigid, stainless steel bowl that has a protective epiglottic lifting bar and a 15 mm lumen that can be used for ventilation. The distal lumen has a stainless steel handle bar connected to it so that adjustments to the bowl can be made for intubation. The endotracheal tube to be used is included with the LMA and is reinforced with metal wire to prevent kinking during placement. To allow for easy insertion through the lumen of the LMA and larynx, there is a latex-free, silicone rubber end on the endotracheal tube. An 8 mm endotracheal tube is the largest tube that can pass through this device.

Conventional endotracheal tubes as well as fiberoptic bronchoscopes may be used through the device. The intubating LMA also has an endotracheal tube pusher that allows the tube to be advanced while the LMA is withdrawn from the oropharynx. Lubrication of the intubation components and the bowl of the LMA is recommended. Since the Fast-Trach LMA contains stainless steel material, it can not be used during an MRI.

Sandberg W, Urman RD, and Ehrenfield JM. The MGH Textbook of Anesthetic Equipment. Philadelphia, PA: Elsevier; 2011: 85-88.

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